

Sithija Shehara

Senior Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 4+ years of experience designing and building scalable web applications using React, Next.js, Node.js, and TypeScript. Experienced in developing enterprise-grade platforms, optimizing frontend performance, and designing reusable component architectures. Proven ability to lead feature development, mentor junior engineers, and deliver high-quality user-centric products. Passionate about building modern web platforms and exploring AI-powered developer tools.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML, CSS, SQL

Frontend: React, Next.js (App Router, React Server Components), Redux, Zustand, Tailwind CSS, SCSS, Shadcn UI, Lexical

Mobile: React Native, Expo

Backend: Node.js, Express.js, Hono, Cloudflare Workers, REST API development

Databases: PostgreSQL, Neon, MongoDB, Firebase, Prisma

Tools: Git, Docker, Azure, Firebase CLI, Vite, Zod, Clerk

Testing: Jest, Vitest, Playwright

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

May 2023 – Present

Aventude

Colombo, Sri Lanka

- Led frontend architecture decisions for a large-scale survey management platform, establishing component design patterns adopted across the team.
- Architected and built a reusable React UI component library, improving development consistency and accelerating delivery across multiple product workstreams.
- Drove performance optimisation initiatives across data fetching and rendering layers, delivering significant reductions in page load times.
- Developed a rich text editor using the Lexical framework and complex analytics dashboards with role-based access control.
- Mentored and onboarded 3–5 junior developers on React, Redux, and frontend best practices, conducting regular code reviews to uphold engineering standards.
- Contributed to sprint planning and technical discussions, bridging engineering considerations with product priorities.

Software Engineer

Mar 2022 – May 2023

Aventude

Colombo, Sri Lanka

- Took end-to-end ownership of key features on a low-code platform built with React and TypeScript, directly improving usability and user adoption.
- Joined a Case Management Solution as a React developer and proactively upskilled in Spring Boot, rapidly familiarising with the full codebase to step up as a full-stack contributor when the team needed it.
- Led the migration of a large legacy codebase from class-based to functional React components with hooks, improving maintainability and developer experience.
- Proactively profiled and resolved API and rendering bottlenecks, contributing to measurable performance gains across the platform.

PROJECTS

Survey Management Platform | *React, TypeScript, Redux, SCSS*

2023 – Present

- Owned the end-to-end redesign of a legacy survey system, making key architectural decisions that significantly improved scalability and long-term maintainability.
- Designed and implemented analytics dashboards with role-based access control, translating complex product requirements into a clean, performant UI.
- Identified and resolved critical performance bottlenecks, reducing page load times and improving responsiveness across the platform.

Lexical Rich Text Editor | *React, TypeScript, Lexical, Vite*

2023 – Present

- Architected a modular rich text editor on Meta's Lexical framework, implementing custom nodes and plugins (tables, polls, inline images, page breaks) with a decoupled toolbar/plugin architecture for extensibility.
- Led incremental upgrades across major Lexical versions (v0.9 to v0.48) and React 18 to 19, migrating off deprecated selection APIs and modernizing the type system without disrupting existing functionality.
- Open-sourced the project as a by-product of internal R&D evaluating Lexical for production use, providing the developer community a maintained starting point for Lexical-based editors; grew to 30+ GitHub stars.

SkillHub - AI Coding Skills Platform | *Next.js, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Prisma, Clerk*

2026 – Present

- Building a community platform that fixes the fragmentation of AI coding tool configurations - prompts, rules, and skill files for Claude, Cursor, and Copilot scattered across gists with no versioning - by centralising them as shareable, forkable, version-controlled "skills".
- Designed a GitHub-inspired collaboration model: immutable version snapshots with changelogs, fork chains for remixing, curated collections with follower feeds, and one-click export to each AI tool's native format.
- Architected a fully type-safe stack (Next.js App Router, React Server Components, Prisma, Zod) with a service-layer API design, tag-based cache invalidation, optimistic updates, and denormalised engagement counters with reconciliation jobs.

SnapBudget - AI-Powered Expense Tracker | *React Native, Cloudflare Workers, Postgres*

2026 – Present

- Building a cross-platform finance app that removes the reason budgeting apps get abandoned - tedious manual entry - with a camera-first flow where an AI vision pipeline (Gemini) extracts the amount, merchant, and category from a receipt photo.
- Architected a full-stack TypeScript system: Expo client, serverless REST API on Cloudflare Workers (Hono) with Neon Postgres, Clerk JWT authentication, and per-user rate limiting at the edge.
- Engineered offline-friendly state with Zustand and optimistic updates (temp-ID reconciliation, rollback on failure) across multi-wallet tracking, per-category budgets with overspend indicators, and spending analytics - verified with a Vitest suite.

EDUCATION

University of Moratuwa

BSc in Information Technology and Management

Moratuwa, Sri Lanka

2017 – 2021